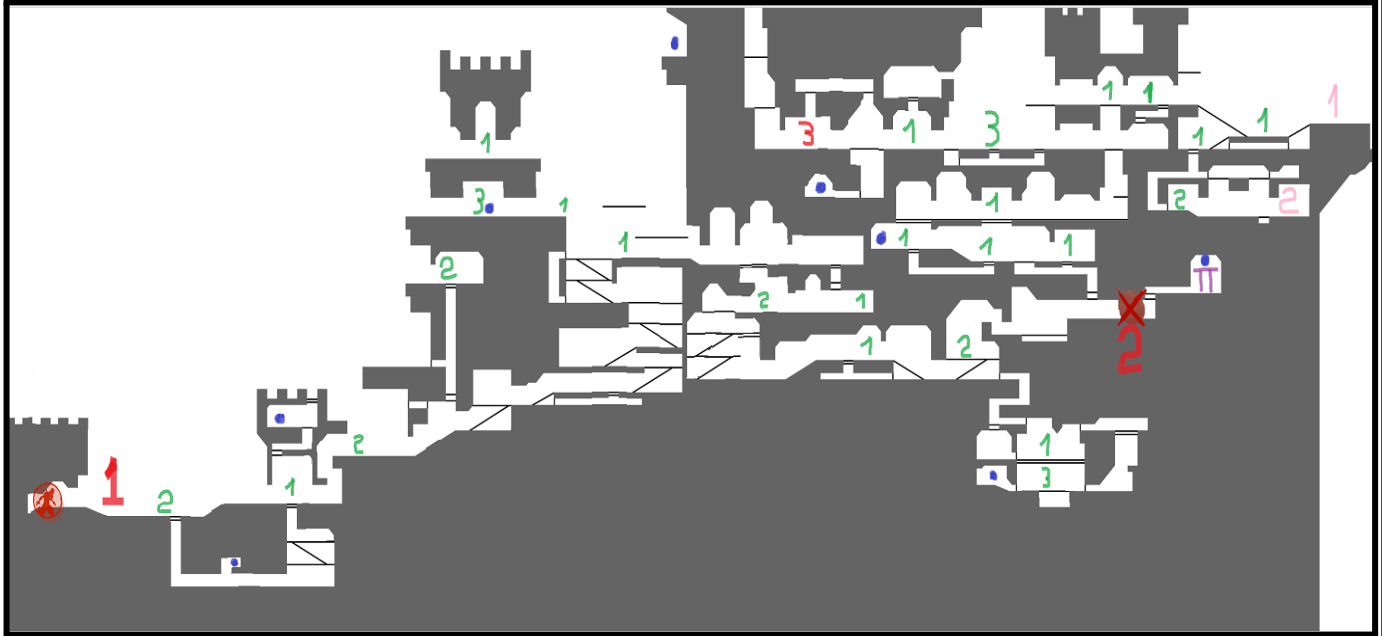


Analysis on Mark of the Ninja

Level design



The map shows:

- ❖ **Red:**
 - 1: Starting point
 - 2: Checkpoint
 - 3: End level
- ❖ **Green:** Number of **guards** in each area
 - They move so their location may change
- ❖ **Pink:** Main mission objectives
- ❖ **Blue:** Collectibles
- ❖ **Purple portal:** Bonus level
 - Unlocks a collectible

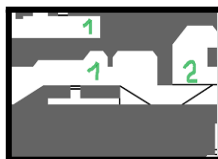
The main objectives lead the player to go left to right while **verticality** has a major role providing multiple ways to enter and interact with the ambient.

Some of the collectibles, optional, are positioned in areas near the main path, while the most of them are in zones that require the player to **exit the main path**. These areas, as shown in the following maps, have a **single way in**, which is in most cases the **only way out**. All collectibles can be grabbed as soon as you reach them, for there is **no backtracking** due to the game genre.

In areas where the player is supposed to pass through, or there is a particular item, the enemies are positioned to provide a **challenge** that can be made easier using the various ninja tools. **All** of them can be **avoided**, and the level can be finished without being **spotted** or having to kill a guard.



In this particular spot is positioned an Elite **Guard**, facing the way the player comes from, that can't be killed in a single hit.

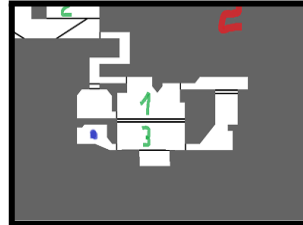


This guard divides the map. On his left the map is highly **horizontal**, despite the climbable tower, while on the right is mostly **vertical** and requires the player to sneak through grids.



The grids provide **different ways** to enter each zone. This gives the player the ability to **choose** their golden path and the option to sneak on enemies, make the rooms dark or entirely avoid them using different items of **distraction**. The [Terror](#) is another option, making the guards **kill** other guards to free the path.

This means that the guards are obstacles, but also weapons when killed, cause they will instill terror in their allies.



In the low-right corner of the map a guard stands **above** three other guards. He can be killed and thrown to them to make them Terrorized and the player can use this distraction to grab the collectibles on the left.

Enemies Behaviour

The different enemies are divided in categories that differentiate in behaviours and fighting style:

- **Guard:** Have a rifle and a torch
- **Elite Guard:** More health than a normal guard and deal more damage
- **Guard Dog:** Can smell the player in the dark and are often alongside guards
- **Flare Guard:** Have a shield forcing the player to approach them from behind. Furthermore they can shoot a flare to light the area
- **Stalker:** Very agile enemies that can move in a similar way to the player's, climb and get into the ducts.



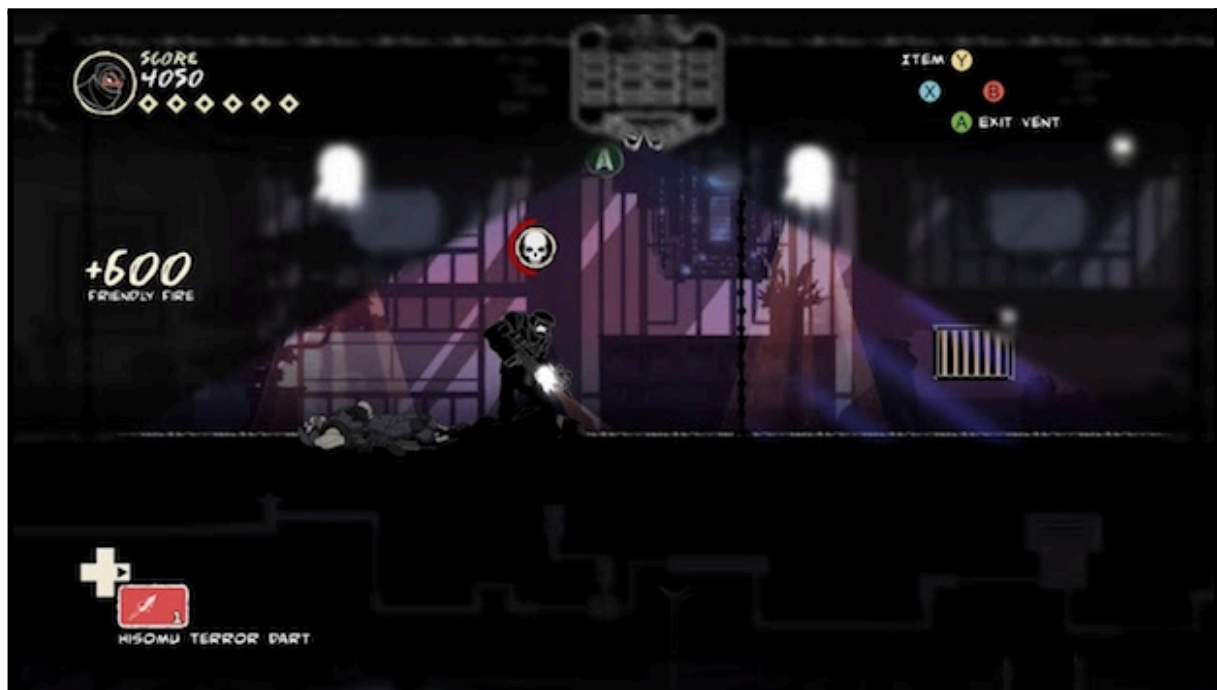
The enemies have a limited range of view but if the player is under the light it will be easier to spot. In the dark they became very easy to kill even when in group, for they don't hear when a fellow guard is killed.



Showing a dead body of a guard to a not alerted one will raise in the latter one the status of **Terror**.

Terror: After having dropped a dead body in front of a guard, it will distract it and will be vulnerable to a backstab.

An enemy in this state will be brought to move for the level in a state of fear, shooting everything he sees (friendly fire). This status can be applied also with objects and abilities.

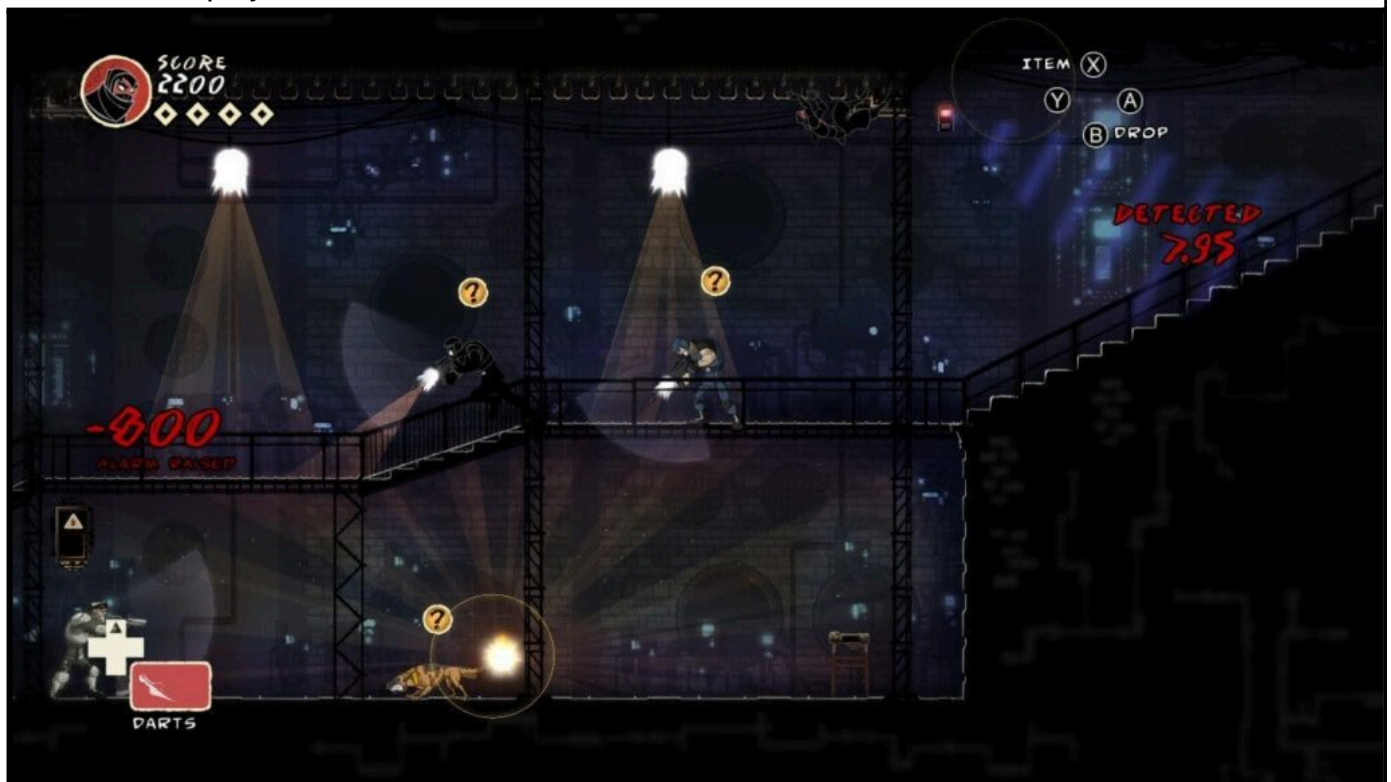


Suspected: A guard noticing a little movement or strange rumors will get suspicious and will be drawn to the point of interest (marked by a yellow circle). Suspicious guards will move much more than their usual path, even surpassing obstacles, drops and interacting with objects like grids. Guards will get suspicious even if the lights are destroyed leaving them in the dark. The player can use a dart to hit a guard and put it in this state. Darts will not hurt the guards.



Alarm: When the player is spotted a combat will start. When enough damage is dealt to a guard, it will drop to the ground exposing itself to a *death attack*. If the guard is not killed in time, it will stand again and continue to fight.

When a guard encounters a dead body or the player, but they run away, will activate an Alarm that will last a minimum 10 seconds. During this time every enemy in the level is alerted and will search for the player.



Sleep: It will be possible to encounter many sleeping enemies. They are vulnerable to a death attack, won't move or notice the player even if they walk near them. Sleeping dogs, on the other

hand, will wake up in the latter case. Raising the **Alarm** will wake up everyone.

Enemies Movement:

Many enemies are stationary in the levels, sometimes acting as a real solution for a puzzle (a laser will deactivate only when they walk underneath it). Other enemies have patrol rounds with a set pattern that will repeat.



Environmental Interaction

Zones not directly accessible to the player or divided by a door are shown dark and empty of details with the enemies non visible. If an enemy disappears into one of these zones it will remain the shape of his last known position, even if he keeps moving.

The player can put the ear to a closed door to hear what's behind it.

Most common actions made by the player are:

- **Lock picking** doors and grids
- **Break** sources of light
- **Climb** any surface (outlined by a white color)
- Climb using the **grappling hook** or lowering himself with it by a ledge
- Use **smoke bombs** to deactivate traps or to run away from enemies
- Make chandeliers or other structures **fall** on top of enemies
- **Drag corpses** to hide them, deactivate alarms or Terrorize other guards

During the game the player might have interactions with background objects like *crows*, that will run seeing the player and will make some noise.

Player footsteps do not emit sound unless they are running. Every sound is outlined by a circle that indicates the range from where it can be heard.



Hiding:

In the rooms where there are multiple enemies there are different spots where to hide. They are usually put in the dark and can be vases, plants, empty spaces in the walls or shut doors in the background. When inside a hiding place it is impossible to kill enemies but enemies can't spot the player although **dogs** will spot the player even if hidden.

Inside hiding spots can be placed dead bodies with the exception of vases and plants. Even ducts protected by a grid can be used as a hiding spot other than as a way to reach optional rooms.

While the player is hidden they can:

- Quickly move to an adjacent hiding spot
- Use objects like darts
- Launch themselves rapidly to a grid or use the grappling hook.

